

UNSHACKLED TRUTH

A FAITH-BASED WORKBOOK
FOR BREAKING FREE



Unshackled Truth

A Faith-Based Workbook for Breaking Free

By Christopher Kelly

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Dedication

*To the One who set me free —
Jesus Christ, my Savior and Redeemer.*

To my family, who loved me through my darkest days.

*To every man and woman still searching for hope —
this is for you.*

Acknowledgments

First and foremost, I thank God for His mercy, grace, and patience toward me. Without Him, none of this would be possible.

To my Mother, whose faith and strength never wavered.

To Chris, Mike, and Smitty — brothers who challenged me, encouraged me, and reminded me what it means to walk in truth.

To Tina — your love, support, and belief in me have been a constant anchor.

To those who confronted me in my nonsense, thank you for giving me the accountability I had lacked for so long.

And to every person who poured into me, whether in a conversation, a prayer, or by example — you were part of God's plan to transform my life.

Opening Statement: How to Use This Workbook

I want you to know something right from the start — this isn't just another workbook with nice thoughts and Bible verses for you to skim through. This is a tool for real change — and I'm not talking about surface-level change where you learn a few new habits and hope life gets better.

I'm talking about the kind of change where God reaches into the deepest parts of you — the parts you don't want anyone to see — and transforms them from the inside out.

I know, because I've lived it. For 22 years I was trapped in addiction, destruction, and a lifestyle that was eating me alive. I had tried to fix myself more times than I can count. Nothing stuck. Nothing worked.

Then God stepped in. And when He did, He didn't just clean me up — He made me new. He changed my heart, renewed my mind, and gave me a purpose that I never thought possible.

It didn't happen overnight and it wasn't easy. There were times I wanted to quit; times I thought it was hopeless. I was also skeptical at first. But I made a decision — I wasn't going to give up at the first sign of discomfort or at the first obstacle. I kept pushing forward. I broke the old habits. I put off the sins that had defined me. And step by step, God shaped me into a new man in Christ.

This workbook is built on that same process — truth from God's Word, applied in real life. Every lesson is designed to do more than just give you information. It will challenge you to take action.

You're going to write, reflect, pray, and put the truth into practice in your everyday life. If you're willing to be honest with yourself, if you'll lean into the discomfort instead of running from it, and if you'll keep going when it gets hard — you *will* see change.

God will meet you where you are, just like He met me. He will walk you through this process, and He will do the work in you that only He can do.

Don't rush it. Take each week seriously. Do the writing. Pray the prayers. Be open to what God is showing you. This is about more than just

breaking free from addiction — it's about becoming the person God created you to be.

I'm living proof it works. And I believe with everything in me that if you give God a chance and don't give up, He will do the same for you.

Set Your Goal Before You Begin

Before we get started, I want you to set a goal for yourself. Not just any goal — a **SMART Goal**. Why? Because vague goals lead to vague results. If you want to see real transformation, you need something clear to aim for.

A SMART Goal is:

- **Specific** – Clear and well-defined.
- **Measurable** – You can track your progress.
- **Achievable** – Doable for where you are right now.
- **Realistic** – Matches your current season and resources.
- **Time-bound** – Has a set deadline so you stay focused.

Example of a SMART Goal:

“By the end of these 18 weeks, I will be reading my Bible at least 5 days a week, journaling my thoughts, and replacing my old morning routine with prayer and Scripture before I check my phone.”

Now, Write Your SMART Goal:

1) Specific – *What exactly do you want to accomplish?*

2) Measurable – *How will you track it?*

3) Achievable – *Is it doable for where you are now?*

4) Realistic – *Does it match your current season and resources?*

5) Time-bound – *When will you accomplish it?*

Final SMART Goal Statement

My Encouragement to You...

This goal is not about impressing anyone — it's about giving yourself a target to aim for so you don't drift. And here's the truth — there will be days you won't feel like doing it. That's when you push through. That's when you remember why you started. That's when you trust God to give you the strength to keep going.

Week 1 - Who God Is

Knowing the One Who Holds All Things Together

Key Scripture

"The LORD is gracious and merciful, slow to anger, and abounding in steadfast love." ~ Psalm 145:8

Quote from a Reformed Theologian

"The greatest need of the human soul is to know God as He truly is." ~ J.I. Packer

Memory Verse

"Be still and know that I am God. I will be exalted among the nations. I will be exalted in the Earth!" ~ Psalm 46:10

Lesson Summary

Before we can understand ourselves, our purpose, or our struggles, we must begin with God. Everything in life flows from who He is. The Bible reveals that God is:

- Holy – Set apart, perfect in all His ways. ~Isaiah 6:3
- Sovereign – Ruler over all creation. ~Psalm 115:3
- Loving – Acting for our good even when we don't see it. ~1 John 4:8
- Just – Always right and fair in His judgments. ~Deuteronomy 32:4
- Faithful – Never failing to keep His promises. ~Lamentations 3:22–23

When we truly know Him, our view of everything changes.

Our past, our future, and our present struggles all come into focus through His character.

Truth to Confront the Lie

The Lie:

"God is distant and uninterested in me."

God's Truth:

"The LORD is near to all who call on Him." ~ Psalm 145:18

The Lie:

"God changes His mind about me."

God's Truth:

"Jesus Christ is the same yesterday and today and forever." ~
Hebrews 13:8

The Lie:

"God doesn't care about my pain."

God's Truth:

"Cast all your anxiety on Him because He cares for you." ~ 1 Peter
5:7

Faith Builder

There was a time when I didn't know who God really was. My ideas about Him came from bits of what I had heard in childhood, from other people's opinions, and from my own misunderstandings. I thought He was more like a distant judge than a loving Father.

It wasn't until I opened the Bible and started asking God to help me understand that I began to see His true character. I realized He wasn't pushing me away — He was inviting me to know Him. That changed everything.

Real-Life Scenario

A friend says, "I believe in God, but I think He's too busy with big things to care about my life." How would you answer them using what you've learned this week?

Exercise – My View of God

List three words that describe how you have viewed God in the past.
Then write three words that describe who He really is according to Scripture.

Reflection Questions

1) Which part of God's character stands out most to you right now?

2) How has your understanding of God been shaped by past experiences or influences?

3) What would change in your life if you fully believed God is who He says He is?

Faith in Action - Head, Heart, Hands

Challenge 1 – Personal:

Spend 10 minutes each day this week reading Psalm 145 and writing one thing it teaches you about God.

- **Head:** What truth about God did I learn?
- **Heart:** How does knowing this truth make me feel toward Him?
- **Hands:** What will I do differently because of this truth?

Challenge 2 – Relational:

Tell someone one truth about God's character that has encouraged you this week.

- **Head:** What truth will I share?
- **Heart:** How does it feel to talk about God openly?
- **Hands:** How will I encourage them to seek Him?

Action Steps

- Read Psalm 145 in full at least three times this week.
 - Memorize Psalm 46:10.
 - Pray each day: “Lord, help me to know You as You truly are.”
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Closing Prayer

Lord, thank You for revealing Yourself through Your Word. Help me to replace false ideas about You with the truth of who You are. Teach me to trust You more as I come to know You better.

~ Amen.

Week 2 - Who Man is According to God

Seeing Ourselves Through the Creator's Eyes

Key Scripture

"So God created man in His own image, in the image of God He created him; male and female; He created them." ~ Genesis 1:27

Quote from a Reformed Theologian

"Without knowledge of self, there is no knowledge of God. Without knowledge of God, there is no knowledge of self." ~ John Calvin

Memory Verse

"For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God." ~ Romans 3:23

Lesson Summary

The world tells us our worth is based on what we do, what we own, or how others see us. But God's Word gives us the true definition of who we are:

- Created in His image (Genesis 1:27) – You are not an accident.
- Designed for relationship with God and others.
- Broken by sin: We have all turned away from God's ways. (Isaiah 53:6)
- Valuable enough to redeem – Jesus paid the ultimate price for you. (1 Peter 1:18–19)

When we ignore God's design, we build false identities based on appearance, reputation, or survival. But when we see ourselves as God does, we find both humility, because we're sinners, and hope, because we're loved.

Truth to Confront the Lie

The Lie:

"I am what I've done."

God's Truth:

"If anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation." ~ 2 Corinthians 5:17

The Lie:

"I have no value."

God's Truth:

"You are precious in My eyes, and honored, and I love you." ~ Isaiah 43:4

The Lie:

"I can decide who I am without God."

God's Truth:

"It is He who made us, and we are His." ~ Psalm 100:3

Faith Builder

When I didn't know who I was, I let the streets define me. I chased validation, power, and an image I thought made me strong. The truth was, I didn't know my worth because I didn't know my Creator.

Prison stripped away the false identities I had built, but at first, that only left me feeling empty. It wasn't until I opened God's Word, and began to see how He describes me that I started to rebuild my life on a foundation that couldn't be shaken.

Real-Life Scenario

You hear someone say, "I'm just a product of my environment. This is who I am — it can't change." How would you answer them using God's truth from this week's lesson?

Exercise – My Identity Inventory

List 3–5 labels you’ve believed about yourself in the past. Then write God’s truth next to each one.

Reflection Questions

1) What false identities have you lived under that were not from God?

2) How does knowing you are created in God’s image change the way you see yourself?

3) Which truth about your identity from Scripture do you need to remember most right now?

Faith in Action - Head, Heart, Hands

Challenge 1 – Personal:

Choose one false label you've believed and replace it with a truth from God's Word. Write it on a card and carry it with you this week.

- **Head:** What truth am I focusing on?
 - **Heart:** How does this truth make me feel about myself?
 - **Hands:** How will I remind myself of it daily?
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Challenge 2 – Relational:

Encourage someone else by telling them one way they reflect God's image.

- **Head:** What truth from Scripture will I share?
 - **Heart:** How does it feel to speak life into them?
 - **Hands:** How will I follow up with them?
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Action Steps

- Read Psalm 139:13–16 every morning this week.
 - Pray daily: “Lord, help me to see myself as You see me.”
 - Share one identity truth with someone else.
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Closing Prayer

Lord, thank You for creating me in Your image. Forgive me for believing lies about who I am. Help me to walk in the truth of my identity as Your child and to see my worth through Your eyes.

~ Amen.

Week 3 - The Fall and the Need for Redemption

Understanding How We Got Here and Why We Need a Savior

Key Scripture

“For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God.” ~ Romans 3:23

Quote from a Reformed Theologian

“You will never appreciate the grace of God until you understand the sinfulness of man.” ~ R.C. Sproul

Memory Verse

“Therefore, just as sin came into the world through one man, and death through sin, and so death spread to all men because all sinned.” ~ Romans 5:12

Lesson Summary

The Bible explains the brokenness we see in the world and in ourselves through the account of The Fall in Genesis 3. Adam and Eve were created perfect in relationship with God, but when they chose to trust their own judgment over God’s Word, sin entered the world. That sin corrupted every part of human nature and brought death, suffering, and separation from God.

The Fall shows us:

- Sin is not just bad behavior — it’s rebellion against God.
- We inherit a sinful nature and cannot fix ourselves.
- All people are equally in need of redemption.
- God’s plan for salvation began immediately after the Fall. ~ Genesis 3:15

Understanding the depth of our problem is the first step toward appreciating the greatness of our Savior.

Truth to Confront the Lie

The Lie:

"People are basically good."

God's Truth:

"None is righteous, no, not one." ~ Romans 3:10

The Lie:

"I can make myself right with God by being a good person."

God's Truth:

"By works of the law no human being will be justified." ~ Romans 3:20

The Lie:

"My sin isn't that bad."

God's Truth:

"The wages of sin is death." ~ Romans 6:23

Faith Builder

I used to believe that as long as I wasn't as bad as the worst of the people I knew, I was doing alright. I compared myself to others instead of to God's standard.

But when I started reading the Bible, I saw the truth — compared to God's holiness, I was guilty.

That realization wasn't meant to crush me, but to drive me to Jesus. Until I saw how much I needed Him, I didn't see how much He had done for me.

Real-Life Scenario

A friend says, "I'm a good person — I've never killed anyone. I think God will let me into heaven." How would you explain to them what the Bible says about sin and redemption?

Exercise – Recognizing My Need for a Savior

Write down 3 areas of your life where you've fallen short of God's standard. Next to each, write how Jesus addresses that need.

Reflection Questions

1) How does understanding the Fall change the way you view yourself?

2) Why is it important to see sin as rebellion against God, not just mistakes?

3) How does knowing the depth of sin make you more grateful for Jesus?

Faith in Action - Head, Heart, Hands

Challenge 1 – Personal:

Read Genesis 3 every day this week and write one sentence about what it shows you about sin and God's response.

- **Head:** What truth stood out to me?
- **Heart:** How does this truth make me feel toward God?
- **Hands:** How will I act differently because of it?

Challenge 2 – Relational:

Have a conversation with someone about why Jesus came — focus on explaining the problem of sin, not just the solution.

- **Head:** What truth will I share?
- **Heart:** How does it feel to explain this to someone?
- **Hands:** How will I follow up with them?

Action Steps

- Read Romans 3 in its entirety this week.
 - Memorize Romans 5:12.
 - Write down one way you can share the truth about sin and redemption with someone this week.
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Closing Prayer

Lord, help me to see the seriousness of sin, not to condemn me, but to make me run to You for grace. Thank You for sending Jesus to redeem what was lost. Help me to live in gratitude and obedience to You.

~ Amen.

Week 4 - God's Plan for Redemption

The Rescue Mission from the Beginning

Key Scripture

"For the Son of Man came to seek and to save the lost." ~ Luke 19:10

Quote from a Reformed Theologian

"From all eternity God has decreed to redeem a people to Himself through the work of His Son. This is the golden thread that runs through all of Scripture." ~ Louis Berkhof

Memory Verse

"But God shows His love for us in that while we were still sinners, Christ died for us." ~ Romans 5:8

Lesson Summary

From the very moment sin entered the world, God set His plan of redemption into motion. Genesis 3:15 — often called the "First Gospel" — promises that a Savior would come to crush the serpent's head.

God's plan of redemption is:

- Rooted in love — God acted because of His deep love for His creation.
- Accomplished through Jesus — The eternal Son of God took on flesh, lived a perfect life, and died in our place.
- Offered to all who believe — Salvation is a gift, received by faith, not earned by works.
- For His glory — Redemption displays the greatness of God's mercy and power.

From Genesis to Revelation, the Bible tells one story about God rescuing His people through His Son, Jesus Christ.

Truth to Confront the Lie

The Lie:

“God is just waiting to punish me.”

God’s Truth:

“God so loved the world, that He gave His only Son.” ~ John 3:16

The Lie:

“I have to fix myself before God will accept me.”

God’s Truth:

“While we were still sinners, Christ died for us.” ~ Romans 5:8

The Lie:

“There’s no way back for me.”

God’s Truth:

“Everyone who calls on the name of the Lord will be saved.” ~
Romans 10:13

Faith Builder

When I first began to understand redemption, I realized it wasn’t about me climbing my way back to God — it was about Him coming down to rescue me. I thought I had to get my life together first, but the truth is, I couldn’t.

It was only when I came to Him, broken, that He began to restore me. I’ve seen men in prison who thought it was too late for them, but when they surrendered to Christ, their lives changed completely.

Real-Life Scenario

Someone tells you, “I believe in God, but I don’t think He could forgive me for the things I’ve done.” How would you use this week’s truth to respond?

Exercise – The Story of Redemption

In your own words, write out God’s plan of redemption from creation to Christ’s return, using Scripture to guide you.

Reflection Questions

1) Why is it important that God’s plan for redemption started immediately after the Fall?

2) How does Romans 5:8 challenge the idea that you must “earn” God’s love?

3) In what ways have you experienced God pursuing you personally?

Faith in Action - Head, Heart, Hands

Challenge 1 – Personal:

Write out Romans 5:8 on a card and carry it with you this week. Every time you feel unworthy, read it aloud.

- **Head:** What truth am I focusing on?
 - **Heart:** How does this truth change the way I see God's love?
 - **Hands:** How will I live differently because of it?
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Challenge 2 – Relational:

Share with one person how God's plan of redemption has changed your life, even if it's just a short conversation.

- **Head:** What part of my story will I share?
 - **Heart:** How does it feel to talk about God's grace?
 - **Hands:** How will I follow up with them?
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Action Steps

- Read Genesis 3:15, Isaiah 53, and John 3 this week.
 - Pray daily: “Lord, thank You for coming after me. Help me to never take Your grace for granted.”
 - Look for one opportunity to share a truth about redemption with someone.
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Closing Prayer

Father, thank You for loving me enough to send Your Son to rescue me. I could never save myself. Help me to rest in the truth that my salvation is Your work from start to finish. Let my life be a reflection of Your redeeming grace.

~ Amen.

Week 5 - Who Am I? (Identity In Christ)

Living From Who God Says You Are

Key Scripture

“Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away; behold, the new has come.” ~ 2 Corinthians 5:17

Quote from a Reformed Theologian

“Our identity is not achieved; it is received in Christ.” ~ Sinclair Ferguson

Memory Verse

“But you are a chosen race, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a people for His own possession, that you may proclaim the excellencies of Him who called you out of darkness into His marvelous light.” ~ 1 Peter 2:9

Lesson Summary

The world tells us to “find ourselves” by looking inward or defining our own truth. But Scripture teaches that our identity is a gift given by the One who created and redeemed us.

In Christ, you are:

- Forgiven – Your past no longer defines you (Ephesians 1:7).
- Adopted – You belong to God’s family (John 1:12).
- Set Apart – You have a purpose in God’s plan (Ephesians 2:10).
- Secure – Nothing can separate you from His love (Romans 8:38–39).

When you live from this identity, you stop chasing validation from the world and start walking in the freedom God intended.

Truth to Confront the Lie

The Lie:

“I am my past mistakes.”

God's Truth:

"As far as the east is from the west, so far does He remove our transgressions from us." ~ Psalm 103:12

The Lie:

"I don't belong anywhere."

God's Truth:

*"You are no longer strangers... but members of the household of God."
~ Ephesians 2:19*

The Lie:

"I have no purpose."

God's Truth:

"For we are His workmanship, created in Christ Jesus for good works." ~ Ephesians 2:10

Faith Builder

For years, my identity was tied to the streets, my reputation, and my ability to survive. In prison, that identity was stripped away, and I didn't know who I was anymore.

It was in that emptiness that God showed me the truth — I wasn't worthless, I wasn't forgotten, and I wasn't beyond repair. I was His.

That truth didn't just change the way I saw myself; it changed the way I lived.

Real-Life Scenario

You overhear someone say, "I'll always be a criminal — that's just who I am now." How could you respond in a way that points them toward their identity in Christ?

Exercise – My Identity in Christ

Write out five truths from Scripture about who you are in Christ. Then write how each one challenges a false belief you've held.

Reflection Questions

1) What false labels or names have you carried that God has removed?

2) Which truth about your identity is hardest for you to believe right now? Why?

3) How would your life look different if you lived each day fully believing who God says you are?

Faith in Action - Head, Heart, Hands

Challenge 1 – Personal:

Choose one identity truth from this week's lesson and declare it out loud every morning for the next 7 days.

- **Head:** What truth am I declaring?
 - **Heart:** How does this truth make me feel about my worth?
 - **Hands:** What specific action will I take to live it out?
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Challenge 2 – Relational:

Encourage someone by reminding them of who they are in Christ, using at least one Scripture.

- **Head:** What truth will I share?
 - **Heart:** How does it feel to speak life into someone else?
 - **Hands:** How will I follow up to keep encouraging them?
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Action Steps

- Read Ephesians 1 and underline every statement of identity in Christ.
 - Write your own “I Am” statement based on Scripture.
 - Memorize 1 Peter 2:9.
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Closing Prayer

Lord, thank You for giving me a new identity in Christ. Help me to reject the lies I've believed and to walk confidently in the truth of who You say I am. Use my life to point others to the freedom found in You.

~ Amen.

Week 6 – Renewing the Mind

Replacing the Lies with God's Truth

Key Scripture

“Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewal of your mind, that by testing you may discern what is the will of God — what is good and acceptable and perfect.” ~

Romans 12:2

Quote from a Reformed Theologian

“The Christian life begins with the mind. God changes the heart through the mind that is renewed by His Word.” ~ Martyn Lloyd-Jones

Memory Verse

“We destroy arguments and every lofty opinion raised against the knowledge of God, and take every thought captive to obey Christ.”

~ 2 Corinthians 10:5

Lesson Summary

Transformation begins in the mind. Before our behavior changes, our thinking must change. That means replacing the lies we've believed with the truth of God's Word.

Renewing the mind means:

- Identifying lies that shape how we see God, ourselves, and the world.
- Confronting those lies with Scripture.
- Choosing daily to think on what is true, honorable, and pure. ~ Philippians 4:8
- Letting God's Word be the filter for every thought, decision, and belief.

This is not a one-time event but a lifelong process and it's the foundation for lasting change.

Truth to Confront the Lie

The Lie:

"I can't control my thoughts."

God's Truth:

"Take every thought captive to obey Christ." ~ 2 Corinthians 10:5

The Lie:

"I've always thought this way, I can't change now."

God's Truth:

"Be transformed by the renewal of your mind." ~ Romans 12:2

The Lie:

"My feelings are more important than the truth."

God's Truth:

"Sanctify them in the truth. Your word is truth." ~ John 17:17

Faith Builder

When I first started trying to change, I thought the battle was about my actions. But I realized the real battle was in my thoughts. I had years of toxic thinking — lies I didn't even realize were lies — and they were driving my choices.

When I began replacing those lies with God's truth, the change started from the inside out. I learned that if my mind is filled with His Word, my life will follow His ways.

Real-Life Scenario

You catch yourself thinking – "I'll never be able to change. I'm too far gone." How would you confront that thought with Scripture?

Exercise – Thought Replacement

Write down three negative or false thoughts you often have. Next to each, write the Scripture that replaces it with truth.

Reflection Questions

1) What is one lie you've believed for most of your life?

2) How has that lie shaped your choices and behavior?

3) What truth from God's Word can replace that lie today?

Faith in Action - Head, Heart, Hands

Challenge 1 – Personal:

Choose one recurring negative thought and replace it with a specific Scripture every time it comes up this week.

- **Head:** What truth will I use to replace the lie?
 - **Heart:** How does that truth make me feel about my situation?
 - **Hands:** What action will I take as a result?
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Challenge 2 – Relational:

Help someone else identify a lie they may be believing and share a Scripture to replace it.

- **Head:** What truth will I share?
 - **Heart:** How does it feel to speak truth into their life?
 - **Hands:** How will I encourage them to keep replacing lies with truth?
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Action Steps

- Read Philippians 4:8 every morning this week.
- Write down one lie you've believed and post God's truth about it somewhere visible.
- Memorize 2 Corinthians 10:5.

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Closing Prayer

Lord, renew my mind daily. Help me to recognize the lies I have believed and replace them with Your truth. Train my thoughts to honor You so that my life reflects the transformation You have begun in me.

~ Amen.

Week 7 - Faith Over Fear

Choosing to Trust God When Fear Speaks Loudest

Key Scripture

"For God gave us a spirit not of fear but of power and love and self-control." ~ 2 Timothy 1:7

Quote from a Reformed Theologian

"Faith is not the absence of fear, but the presence of trust in the God, who is greater than our fear." ~ Charles Spurgeon

Memory Verse

"When I am afraid, I put my trust in You." ~ Psalm 56:3

Lesson Summary

Fear is one of the greatest obstacles to walking in freedom. It keeps us clinging to old habits, relationships, or lifestyles because the unknown feels too risky.

Faith doesn't mean you'll never feel fear — it means you choose to trust God anyway.

Living with faith over fear means:

- Believing God's promises are true, even when you can't see the outcome.
- Remembering His past faithfulness in your life.
- Stepping forward in obedience despite uncertainty.
- Letting God's Word be louder than your fear.

Truth to Confront the Lie

The Lie:

"I can't take that first step — it's too risky."

God's Truth:

"The LORD will fight for you; you need only to be still." ~ Exodus 14:14

The Lie:

“If I let go of this, I’ll have nothing left.”

God’s Truth:

“Fear not, for I am with you.” ~ Isaiah 41:10

The Lie:

“I’m not strong enough to do this.”

God’s Truth:

“My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is made perfect in weakness.” ~ 2 Corinthians 12:9

Faith Builder

When I thought about walking away from the lifestyle I knew, I was terrified. Prison had its dangers, but it was familiar. Stepping into something new — following God’s way — felt like walking blindfolded.

But every step of faith I took, God met me there. Sometimes the hardest step was just the first one, but it led to doors I never thought would open. Looking back, I see that nothing worth having came without pain and struggle, but every time I chose faith over fear — I grew stronger.

Real-Life Scenario

You’ve been invited to join a Bible study, but you’re afraid of being judged because of your past. How could you respond in faith instead of letting fear hold you back?

Exercise – Fear Inventory

Write down 3 fears that are holding you back right now. Next to each one, write a Scripture that speaks to it and a step of faith you can take this week.

Reflection Questions

1) What fear has most often kept you from obeying God?

2) How has God proven Himself faithful to you in the past?

3) What's one step of faith you can take this week despite fear?

Faith in Action - Head, Heart, Hands

Challenge 1 – Personal:

Write down one fear and speak a truth from God's Word over it every morning this week.

- **Head:** What truth will I speak?
 - **Heart:** How does that truth affect how I feel about this fear?
 - **Hands:** What step will I take in faith this week?
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Challenge 2 – Relational:

Encourage someone else who is facing fear by sharing how God helped you take a step of faith.

- **Head:** What part of my story will I share?
 - **Heart:** How does it feel to give someone courage through my testimony?
 - **Hands:** How will I check in on them after they take their step?
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Action Steps

- Read Joshua 1:1–9 and underline every command or promise about courage.
 - Pray daily: “Lord, help me choose faith over fear today.”
 - Memorize Psalm 56:3.
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Closing Prayer

Lord, You know my fears before I even speak them. Thank You for promising to be with me. Give me courage to take the steps You are calling me to, even when I feel afraid. Let my life be a testimony of faith that overcomes fear.

~ Amen.

Week 8 - Grace Over Shame

Letting God's Grace Speak Louder Than Your Past

Key Scripture

"There is therefore now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus." ~ Romans 8:1

Quote from a Reformed Theologian

"When God forgives, He does not merely remove the guilt of sin, but He removes the shame of it as well." ~ John Murray

Memory Verse

"As far as the east is from the west, so far does He remove our transgressions from us." ~ Psalm 103:12

Lesson Summary

Shame is a heavy weight — it convinces us we are defined by our worst moments. While guilt says, "I did something bad.", shame says, "I am bad."

But God's grace changes that.

Grace is:

- Unmerited favor: God's kindness toward us that we cannot earn. ~ Ephesians 2:8–9
- Transforming power: Grace doesn't just forgive; it changes who we are. ~ Titus 2:11–12
- Shame-breaking truth: In Christ, you are no longer bound by the labels of your past.

Grace calls us out of hiding and into the freedom of being fully known and fully loved.

Truth to Confront the Lie

The Lie:

"I'll always be defined by what I've done."

God's Truth:

"If anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation." ~ 2 Corinthians 5:17

The Lie:

"God forgives me, but I can't forgive myself."

God's Truth:

"There is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus." ~ Romans 8:1

The Lie:

"If people really knew me, they would reject me."

God's Truth:

"Nothing... will be able to separate us from the love of God." ~ Romans 8:38–39

Faith Builder

I carried shame like a badge — not because I was proud of what I'd done, but because I believed it was who I was.

Even when I started to follow Christ, I still found myself replaying old failures in my mind. But the more I read God's Word, the more I saw that shame had no place in my new life.

Grace didn't just cancel my debt — it rewrote my story.

Real-Life Scenario

Someone says, "I know God forgives me, but I still feel dirty inside." How could you respond with the truth of grace?

Exercise – Rewriting My Story

Write down one thing from your past that has caused you shame. Then write a Scripture truth that covers it with grace.

Reflection Questions

1) What past event or sin still triggers shame in your life?

2) How does God's grace speak to that specific area?

3) How would your life look if you truly believed your shame was removed?

Faith in Action - Head, Heart, Hands

Challenge 1 – Personal:

Write Psalm 103:12 on a card and read it every time you feel shame trying to creep back in.

- **Head:** What truth am I reminding myself of?
 - **Heart:** How does this truth make me feel about my past?
 - **Hands:** What step will I take to walk in grace this week?
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Challenge 2 – Relational:

Share a personal testimony with someone about how God's grace covered your shame.

- **Head:** What part of my story will I share?
 - **Heart:** How does it feel to share openly about my past?
 - **Hands:** How can I encourage them to trust God's grace?
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Action Steps

- Read Ephesians 2:1–10.
- Pray daily: “Lord, help me live in the freedom of Your grace.”
- Memorize Psalm 103:12.

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Closing Prayer

Lord, thank You for removing my shame and covering me with grace. Help me to see myself the way You see me and to extend that same grace to others.

~ Amen.

Week 9 – Freedom From Guilt

Walking in the Forgiveness God Has Already Given

Key Scripture

“If we confess our sins, He is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness.” ~ 1 John 1:9

Quote from a Reformed Theologian

“The blood of Christ is not only sufficient to pardon the guilt of sin, but also to cleanse the conscience from its stain.” ~ John Owen

Memory Verse

“Blessed is the one whose transgression is forgiven, whose sin is covered.” ~ Psalm 32:1

Lesson Summary

Guilt is the inner reminder that we’ve done wrong — and when it’s unresolved, it can become a constant weight on our soul. God uses conviction to lead us to repentance and restoration. But condemning guilt — the kind that lingers even after we’ve confessed — is not from Him.

Freedom from guilt means:

- Believing Christ’s sacrifice was enough to cover all your sins. ~ Hebrews 10:14
- Choosing to accept His forgiveness instead of holding onto self-punishment.
- Living each day in gratitude instead of regret.

When God forgives, He doesn’t keep a record against you.

Neither should you.

Truth to Confront the Lie

The Lie:

“I have to keep punishing myself for what I’ve done.”

God's Truth:

"There is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus." ~
Romans 8:1

The Lie:

"Some sins are just too big to be forgiven."

God's Truth:

"Though your sins are like scarlet, they shall be as white as snow." ~
Isaiah 1:18

The Lie:

"God forgave me, but I can't move on."

God's Truth:

"Forgetting what lies behind... I press on toward the goal." ~
Philippians 3:13-14

Faith Builder

I used to think feeling guilty was a sign of humility. I thought holding onto my guilt somehow showed God I was sorry enough. But what I didn't realize was that holding onto guilt was actually saying, "Jesus, Your sacrifice wasn't enough for me."

The day I truly believed that my sins were nailed to the cross and paid for in full, I felt a freedom I had never experienced.

I didn't have to earn it. I just had to receive it.

Real-Life Scenario

A friend says, "I believe in God, but I still feel like I owe Him something for all I've done wrong." How could you help them see the truth about forgiveness?

Exercise – Laying Down the Guilt

Write down one thing you've already confessed to God but still feel guilty about. Now, next to it, write the truth from Scripture that shows it's been forgiven.

Reflection Questions

1) What's one thing you've had trouble believing God has forgiven you for?

2) How has holding onto guilt affected your relationship with God?

3) What would it look like to walk in complete freedom from that guilt?

Faith in Action - Head, Heart, Hands

Challenge 1 – Personal:

Every morning this week, thank God for His forgiveness and name one specific sin you know He has covered.

- **Head:** What truth am I declaring?
 - **Heart:** How does that truth free me emotionally?
 - **Hands:** What step will I take to live like I'm forgiven?
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Challenge 2 – Relational:

Encourage someone else by sharing how God freed you from guilt and give them a Scripture that speaks to forgiveness.

- **Head:** What truth will I share?
 - **Heart:** How does it feel to help someone see they can be forgiven?
 - **Hands:** How will I follow up to see how they're walking in that truth?
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Action Steps

- Read Psalm 32 and Psalm 103.
 - Memorize Psalm 32:1.
 - Each time guilt resurfaces, speak Romans 8:1 out loud.
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Closing Prayer

Lord, thank You for the complete forgiveness You have given through Jesus. Help me to stop carrying what You have already taken away. Teach me to live in the joy and peace of a cleansed conscience.

~ Amen.

Week 10 - The Power Of Forgiveness

Releasing Others as God Has Released You

Key Scripture

“Be kind to one another, tenderhearted, forgiving one another, as God in Christ forgave you.” ~ Ephesians 4:32

Quote from a Reformed Theologian

“The man who has truly known the grace of God will not find it hard to show grace to others.” ~ Charles Spurgeon

Memory Verse

“For if you forgive others their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you.” ~ Matthew 6:14

Lesson Summary

Forgiveness is one of the most powerful acts a believer can walk in — but it’s also one of the most costly. It means choosing to release someone from the debt they owe you, just as God released you from yours.

True forgiveness:

- Is not ignoring or excusing wrong — it’s releasing the right to revenge.
- Is an act of obedience to God, not a feeling.
- Frees both the one who forgives and the one forgiven.
- Reflects the heart of Christ, who forgave even those who crucified Him (Luke 23:34).

Forgiveness doesn’t erase the memory, but it breaks the power of bitterness and allows healing to begin.

Truth to Confront the Lie

The Lie:

“If I forgive, I’m letting them get away with it.”

God's Truth:

"Vengeance is Mine, I will repay, says the Lord." ~ Romans 12:19

The Lie:

"They don't deserve my forgiveness."

God's Truth:

"While we were still sinners, Christ died for us." ~ Romans 5:8

The Lie:

"Forgiving means I have to trust them again."

God's Truth:

"Be wise as serpents and innocent as doves." ~ Matthew 10:16

Faith Builder

I held grudges for years, thinking it was my way of protecting myself. In reality, the unforgiveness I carried was only poisoning me. It consumed my thoughts, hardened my heart, and kept me from fully experiencing God's peace. When I finally forgave — truly forgave — the weight lifted. I realized forgiveness wasn't about excusing what was done; it was about choosing not to be chained to it any longer. God had set me free, and He was calling me to set others free as well.

Real-Life Scenario

A friend says, "I can't forgive them. They don't deserve it." How would you respond in light of God's forgiveness toward you?

Exercise – My Forgiveness List

Write down the name of one person you've struggled to forgive. Beside their name, write one way you can release them to God this week.

Reflection Questions

1) Who is one person God is calling you to forgive?

2) What's the biggest obstacle keeping you from forgiving them?

3) How has unforgiveness affected your life, thoughts, and relationships?

Faith in Action - Head, Heart, Hands

Challenge 1 – Personal:

Pray daily this week for the person you need to forgive, asking God to soften your heart toward them.

- **Head:** What truth am I holding onto about forgiveness?
 - **Heart:** How does praying for them change my feelings toward them?
 - **Hands:** What step can I take to show grace this week?
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Challenge 2 – Relational:

Share with someone how forgiving another person brought you freedom, and encourage them to do the same.

- **Head:** What part of my story will I share?
 - **Heart:** How does sharing this give me a deeper appreciation for God's grace?
 - **Hands:** How can I support them in their journey to forgive?
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Action Steps

- Read Matthew 18:21–35 and reflect on the parable of the unforgiving servant.
 - Memorize Matthew 6:14.
 - Each time bitterness rises, speak Ephesians 4:32 out loud.
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Closing Prayer

Lord, thank You for forgiving me more than I could ever repay. Help me to extend that same forgiveness to others, trusting You with justice and healing. Break the chains of bitterness and fill my heart with Your peace.

~ Amen.

Week 11 - Identity In Christ

Seeing Yourself the Way God Sees You

Key Scripture

“Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away; behold, the new has come.” ~ 2 Corinthians 5:17

Quote from a Reformed Theologian

“Our identity is not in what we have done or in what has been done to us, but in what Christ has done for us.” ~ Sinclair Ferguson

Memory Verse

“But you are a chosen race, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a people for His own possession...” ~ 1 Peter 2:9

Lesson Summary

Before Christ, our identity was shaped by our upbringing, experiences, mistakes, and the voices around us. Many of us lived out of false identities rooted in shame, rejection, or rebellion. When we come to Christ, everything changes — not just our behavior, but who we are.

In Christ, you are:

- Forgiven (Colossians 1:14)
- Loved (Romans 8:38–39)
- Adopted into God’s family (Ephesians 1:5)
- Set apart for His purpose (2 Timothy 1:9)
- Given a new heart and mind (Ezekiel 36:26)

Learning to live out of this new identity takes intentional renewal of the mind through God’s Word.

Truth to Confront the Lie

The Lie:

“I’ll always be the same person I used to be.”

God's Truth:

"The old has passed away; behold, the new has come." ~ 2 Corinthians 5:17

The Lie:

"I'm defined by my failures."

God's Truth:

"You are a chosen race... a people for His own possession." ~ 1 Peter 2:9

The Lie:

"I have no real value."

God's Truth:

"You were bought with a price." ~ 1 Corinthians 6:20

Faith Builder

For years, I didn't know who I was — so I chased validation from friends, relationships, and dangerous choices. I followed the wrong crowd because I didn't know what I stood for.

It wasn't until Christ began to show me my worth in Him that my life started to change. My past didn't have to define me anymore. God gave me a new name, a new purpose, and a new future.

Real-Life Scenario

Someone says, "I can't see myself as anything other than the person I've always been." How could you help them see their new identity in Christ?

Exercise – My New Name

Write down three labels you've carried in the past (e.g., "addict," "failure," "angry"). Next to each, write the new identity God has given you through His Word.

Reflection Questions

1) What old label or identity do you still struggle to let go of?

2) Which truth about your new identity in Christ speaks to you most right now?

3) How can knowing your identity in Christ change the way you live?

Faith in Action - Head, Heart, Hands

Challenge 1 – Personal:

Write 1 Peter 2:9 on a card and read it aloud each morning this week, replacing “you” with your own name.

- **Head:** What truth am I declaring over myself?
 - **Heart:** How does that truth change the way I feel about my worth?
 - **Hands:** What step will I take to live as God’s chosen child this week?
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Challenge 2 – Relational:

Share with someone how Christ has redefined your identity, and ask them to share one thing they believe God says about them.

- **Head:** What truth will I share about my transformation?
 - **Heart:** How does talking about my identity strengthen my faith?
 - **Hands:** How will I continue encouraging them in their identity?
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Action Steps

- Read Ephesians 1 and underline every phrase that describes who you are in Christ.
 - Memorize 1 Peter 2:9.
 - Replace any negative self-talk with Scripture truth.
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Closing Prayer

Lord, thank You for giving me a new identity in Christ. Help me to see myself the way You see me, and give me the courage to live out of that truth every day.

~ Amen.

Week 12 - Renewing The Mind

Aligning Your Thoughts with God's Truth

Key Scripture

"Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewal of your mind..." ~ Romans 12:2

Quote from a Reformed Theologian

"The mind is the battlefield on which the Christian life is won or lost." ~ R.C. Sproul

Memory Verse

"...take every thought captive to obey Christ." ~ 2 Corinthians 10:5

Lesson Summary

Our actions flow from our thoughts. If our thinking is shaped by the world's values, our lives will reflect that. But when we renew our minds with God's Word, transformation begins from the inside out.

Renewing the mind means:

- Rejecting lies we've believed about ourselves, others, and God.
- Replacing them with the truth of Scripture.
- Reinforcing those truths through prayer, worship, and obedience.

This isn't a one-time event — it's a daily process. Each thought must be weighed against God's truth before it's allowed to take root.

Truth to Confront the Lie

The Lie:

"I can't change the way I think."

God's Truth:

"Be transformed by the renewal of your mind." ~ Romans 12:2

The Lie:

"My thoughts don't matter as long as I do the right thing."

God's Truth:

"As he thinks in his heart, so is he." ~ Proverbs 23:7

The Lie:

"This is just the way I am."

God's Truth:

"If anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation." ~ 2 Corinthians 5:17

Faith Builder

For years, I didn't realize my thoughts were driving my choices. I told myself I'd always be stuck in the same patterns, and guess what? I was.

When I began replacing those lies with God's truth, my actions started to follow. I learned that I can't just stop bad thoughts — I have to replace them with the Word of God.

Real-Life Scenario

A friend says, "I just can't stop thinking negative thoughts." How could you guide them toward renewing their mind according to Scripture?

Exercise – Thought Inventory

Write down three thoughts you often have that don't line up with God's truth. Next to each, write a Scripture that replaces that thought with truth.

Reflection Questions

1) What negative or unbiblical thought patterns have you accepted as “normal”?

2) How does God’s Word directly address those thought patterns?

3) What’s one practical step you can take this week to renew your mind daily?

Faith in Action - Head, Heart, Hands

Challenge 1 – Personal:

Each morning, read one verse that counters a lie you've been believing and speak it out loud.

- **Head:** What truth am I focusing on today?
 - **Heart:** How does believing this truth change my outlook?
 - **Hands:** What step will I take to live in light of this truth?
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Challenge 2 – Relational:

Encourage someone else by sharing a Scripture that has helped renew your mind.

- **Head:** What truth will I share with them?
 - **Heart:** How does it feel to pass on encouragement?
 - **Hands:** How can I help them put this truth into practice?
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Action Steps

- Read Philippians 4:8 daily and use it as a filter for your thoughts.
- Memorize 2 Corinthians 10:5.

- Replace every negative thought this week with a specific Bible verse.

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Closing Prayer

Lord, renew my mind each day with Your truth. Help me to recognize lies quickly and replace them with Your Word, so my life reflects Your will.

~ Amen.

Week 13 - Breaking Strongholds

Tearing Down the Lies That Hold You Captive

Key Scripture

“For the weapons of our warfare are not of the flesh but have divine power to destroy strongholds.” ~ 2 Corinthians 10:4

Quote from a Reformed Theologian

“Sin gets its power by persuading me to believe that I will be more happy if I follow it.” ~ John Piper

Memory Verse

“So if the Son sets you free, you will be free indeed.” ~ John 8:36

Lesson Summary

A stronghold is a mindset, belief, or habit that keeps you stuck and resists God’s truth. It can be built from:

- Repeated sinful choices
- Lies we’ve believed since childhood
- Trauma that shaped our identity
- Cultural values that contradict God’s Word

Strongholds don’t come down by willpower — they’re destroyed by God’s truth applied through faith and obedience.

To break a stronghold, we must:

1. Identify it – Name the thought pattern or behavior that has a grip on you.
2. Confront it – Replace it with Scripture truth.
3. Persist – Keep applying truth until the stronghold crumbles.

Truth to Confront the Lie

The Lie:

“I’ll never be free from this.”

God's Truth:

"So if the Son sets you free, you will be free indeed." ~ John 8:36

The Lie:

"This is just part of who I am."

God's Truth:

"The old has passed away; behold, the new has come." ~ 2
Corinthians 5:17

The Lie:

"I'm powerless against this temptation."

God's Truth:

"God... will also provide the way of escape." ~ 1 Corinthians 10:13

Faith Builder

Some of the strongest chains in my life weren't physical — they were in my mind. I had accepted lies about who I was and what I could never change.

But the moment I believed God's truth more than the lies, those chains started to crack. It didn't happen overnight, but as I kept choosing His Word over my old thinking, the strongholds fell.

Real-Life Scenario

A brother in Christ says, "I've prayed about it for years, but this sin just won't go away." How could you encourage him with biblical steps for breaking strongholds?

Exercise – Stronghold Map

1. Identify one stronghold in your life.
2. Write down the lie at the root of it.
3. Find a Scripture that speaks directly against that lie.
4. Write one action step you will take this week to walk in truth.

Reflection Questions

1) What mindset or habit has been hardest for you to break?

2) What lie is feeding that stronghold?

3) Which Scripture can you cling to as your weapon against it?

Faith in Action - Head, Heart, Hands

Challenge 1 – Personal:

Every time you feel the pull of your stronghold this week, speak your chosen Scripture out loud.

- **Head:** What truth am I standing on?
 - **Heart:** How does speaking it shift my emotions in the moment?
 - **Hands:** What action will I take instead of giving in?
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Challenge 2 – Relational:

Share with a trusted believer what stronghold you're working to break and invite them to pray with you.

- **Head:** What truth will I share with them?
 - **Heart:** How does inviting someone in bring hope?
 - **Hands:** How will I follow up with them on my progress?
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Action Steps

- Read 2 Corinthians 10:3–5 daily.
 - Memorize John 8:36.
 - Replace the lie feeding your stronghold with Scripture every time it surfaces.
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Closing Prayer

Lord, expose every stronghold in my life and give me the courage to confront it with Your truth. Thank You that Your Word is powerful enough to set me free.

~ Amen.

Week 14 - Overcoming Temptation

Choosing God's Way When the Pressure is On

Key Scripture

"No temptation has overtaken you that is not common to man. God is faithful, and He will not let you be tempted beyond your ability, but with the temptation He will also provide the way of escape, that you may be able to endure it." ~ 1 Corinthians 10:13

Quote from a Reformed Theologian

"We are not tempted because we are weak; we are tempted because we are human. But God has given us His Spirit so that we need not fall." ~ John Owen

Memory Verse

"Submit yourselves therefore to God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you." ~ James 4:7

Lesson Summary

Temptation is not sin — but entertaining it often leads to sin. Every believer will face it, and the enemy knows our weak points.

Overcoming temptation involves:

- Recognizing the bait before it hooks you.
- Remembering God's Word in the moment of pressure.
- Relying on the Holy Spirit for strength.
- Removing yourself from the situation when needed.

God always provides a way out — but we must choose to take it.

Truth to Confront the Lie

The Lie:

"I couldn't help it — the temptation was too strong."

God's Truth:

"God... will also provide the way of escape." ~ 1 Corinthians 10:13

The Lie:

"It's not that big of a deal."

God's Truth:

"The wages of sin is death." ~ Romans 6:23

The Lie:

"I've already failed, so I might as well keep going."

God's Truth:

"If we confess our sins, He is faithful... to cleanse us." ~ 1 John 1:9

Faith Builder

In prison, temptation didn't stop just because I was locked up. If anything, it came harder — through anger, pride, and old habits calling my name.

I learned that the moment I felt that pull, I had to make a choice: believe the lie that it was harmless or take God's way out. The more I chose His escape route, the stronger I became against the next attack.

Real-Life Scenario

A friend says, "I know I shouldn't do it, but I can't stop myself when the opportunity comes." How would you walk them through finding God's "way of escape"?

Exercise – My Escape Plan

1. Identify one temptation you face regularly.
2. Write the specific Scripture that speaks against it.
3. Write down the "escape route" you will take the next time it comes.

Reflection Questions

1) What temptation do you face most often?

2) What is usually the trigger for this temptation?

3) How can you prepare now to take God's way of escape in the moment?

Faith in Action - Head, Heart, Hands

Challenge 1 – Personal:

Memorize one verse that speaks directly to your most common temptation and say it every time the urge comes.

- **Head:** What truth am I guarding my mind with?
 - **Heart:** How does remembering this truth change my desire in the moment?
 - **Hands:** What action will I take instead of giving in?
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Challenge 2 – Relational:

Share with a trusted believer the temptation you're facing and ask them to hold you accountable this week.

- **Head:** What truth will I ask them to remind me of?
 - **Heart:** How does having someone check in strengthen me?
 - **Hands:** How will I respond if I start feeling tempted?
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Action Steps

- Read Matthew 4:1–11 and study how Jesus overcame temptation.

- Memorize James 4:7.
- Identify and remove triggers that make temptation harder to resist.

[illegible]

Closing Prayer

Lord, thank You for always providing a way out of temptation. Give me the courage to take it, the wisdom to see it, and the strength to say “no” when my flesh wants to say “yes.”

~ Amen.

Week 15 - Enduring Trials

Standing Firm When Life Gets Hard

Key Scripture

“Blessed is the man who remains steadfast under trial, for when he has stood the test he will receive the crown of life, which God has promised to those who love Him.” ~ James 1:12

Quote from a Reformed Theologian

“Afflictions are not signs of God’s displeasure, but tokens of His love, for by them He makes us partakers of His holiness.” ~ John Calvin

Memory Verse

“Count it all joy, my brothers, when you meet trials of various kinds...” ~ James 1:2

Lesson Summary

Trials are unavoidable in the Christian life. They test our faith, refine our character, and deepen our dependence on God. While the world tells us to avoid pain at all costs, Scripture teaches us to embrace trials as opportunities for growth.

Enduring trials means:

- Trusting that God is sovereign over every circumstance.
- Believing that He uses trials for our good and His glory.
- Choosing joy not because the trial is pleasant, but because the outcome will be worth it.

Truth to Confront the Lie

The Lie:

“If God loved me, He wouldn’t let this happen.”

God’s Truth:

“For the Lord disciplines the one He loves.” ~ Hebrews 12:6

The Lie:

"This trial is pointless."

God's Truth:

"We know that for those who love God all things work together for good." ~ Romans 8:28

The Lie:

"I can't handle this."

God's Truth:

"My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is made perfect in weakness." ~ 2 Corinthians 12:9

Faith Builder

I used to think trials were proof that God had abandoned me. But I learned in prison that some of my deepest growth came from the hardest seasons.

It was in those moments — when the walls felt like they were closing in — that I discovered God was shaping me, stripping away false strength, and building a faith that could stand in the storm.

Real-Life Scenario

A brother in Christ says, "I just don't understand why God would let this happen." How could you help them see God's purpose in trials?

Exercise – Trial Tracker

1. Write down one current or past trial.
2. List three possible ways God might be using it for your growth.

3. Pray over each one, asking for His wisdom to see the bigger picture.

Reflection Questions

1) How do you usually respond to trials — with trust, or with frustration?

2) What is one truth about God you need to hold onto in your current trial?

3) How can this trial strengthen your faith for the future?

Faith in Action - Head, Heart, Hands

Challenge 1 – Personal:

Each day this week, thank God for one way your trial is drawing you closer to Him.

- **Head:** What truth reminds me that this trial has purpose?
 - **Heart:** How does gratitude shift my perspective?
 - **Hands:** What faithful action can I take despite the difficulty?
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Challenge 2 – Relational:

Encourage someone who is going through a trial by sharing a story of how God brought you through one.

- **Head:** What lesson from my past trial can I share?
 - **Heart:** How can my story offer them hope?
 - **Hands:** What tangible way can I support them right now?
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Action Steps

- Read James 1:2–4 daily.
- Memorize James 1:2.
- Look for opportunities to minister to others out of your own trials.

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Closing Prayer

Lord, thank You that my trials are not wasted. Help me to endure with joy, trusting that You are using every difficulty to shape me into the image of Christ.

~ Amen.

Week 16 - Living With Eternal Perspective

Keeping Your Eyes on What Truly Matters

Key Scripture

“So we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, our inner self is being renewed day by day. For this light momentary affliction is preparing for us an eternal weight of glory beyond all comparison...” ~ 2 Corinthians 4:16–17

Quote from a Reformed Theologian

“When the heart is set on eternity, the burdens of the moment grow strangely light.” ~ Jonathan Edwards

Memory Verse

“Set your minds on things that are above, not on things that are on earth.” ~ Colossians 3:2

Lesson Summary

We live in a world obsessed with the here and now — possessions, status, comfort, and temporary success. But Scripture calls us to fix our eyes on what lasts forever.

An eternal perspective changes:

- How we see trials — as preparation for glory.
- How we handle temptation — knowing our reward is in heaven.
- How we live daily — choosing what pleases God over what pleases man.

When we live with eternity in view, we stop clinging to things we can't keep and start investing in what will never fade.

Truth to Confront the Lie

The Lie:

“This life is all there is.”

God's Truth:

"We look... to the things that are unseen. For the things that are seen are transient." ~ 2 Corinthians 4:18

The Lie:

"I have to get everything I can now."

God's Truth:

"Do not lay up for yourselves treasures on earth... but lay up treasures in heaven." ~ Matthew 6:19-20

The Lie:

"What I do now doesn't really matter in the long run."

God's Truth:

"We must all appear before the judgment seat of Christ." ~ 2 Corinthians 5:10

Faith Builder

There was a time I lived like there was no tomorrow — reckless, chasing pleasure, ignoring consequences. Prison slowed me down, but it wasn't until I met Christ that I started looking beyond my next meal, next fight, or next release date.

Eternity changed my priorities. The things I thought mattered so much started to fade, and God's mission became the reason I got up every morning.

Real-Life Scenario

Someone says, "I just want to live for today — tomorrow isn't promised." How would you explain the difference between enjoying life and living with eternity in mind?

Exercise – Eternal Inventory

1. Write down three things you spend the most time, energy, or money on.
2. Circle which ones will matter 100 years from now.
3. Ask God to help you invest more in what has eternal value.

Reflection Questions

1) What does “eternal perspective” mean to you personally?

2) How would your daily priorities change if you truly lived with eternity in mind?

3) What is one temporary thing you need to hold more loosely?

Faith in Action - Head, Heart, Hands

Challenge 1 – Personal:

Read Colossians 3:1–4 each morning this week and ask God to align your focus with eternal things.

- **Head:** What truth am I focusing on?
 - **Heart:** How does this truth change my values?
 - **Hands:** What action will I take today that will matter in eternity?
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Challenge 2 – Relational:

Share one thing God has taught you about living for eternity with a friend or family member.

- **Head:** What truth will I share?
 - **Heart:** How does sharing it deepen my own conviction?
 - **Hands:** How will I encourage them to live with eternity in view?
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Action Steps

- Read 2 Corinthians 4:16–18 daily.
 - Memorize Colossians 3:2.
 - Identify one temporary pursuit you can replace with an eternal investment.
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Closing Prayer

Lord, fix my eyes on eternity so I can live today with purpose. Help me to invest in what will last forever and let go of what will not follow me into Your kingdom.

~ Amen.

Week 17 - Walking In Daily Surrender

Yielding Every Moment to God's Will

Key Scripture

"I have been crucified with Christ. It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me. And the life I now live in the flesh I live by faith in the Son of God, who loved me and gave Himself for me." ~ Galatians 2:20

Quote from a Reformed Theologian

"The essence of the Christian life is surrender: our will for His will, our way for His way, our glory for His glory." ~ A.W. Pink

Memory Verse

"Trust in the Lord with all your heart, and do not lean on your own understanding. In all your ways acknowledge Him, and He will make straight your paths." ~ Proverbs 3:5-6

Lesson Summary

Surrender is not a one-time event at salvation — it's a daily, moment-by-moment choice. Every day we are faced with decisions that reveal whether we will follow our own plans or submit to God's.

Daily surrender means:

- Yielding control of our lives to God.
- Trusting His wisdom even when we don't understand His plan.
- Obeying quickly when His Spirit prompts us to act.

Surrender is not weakness — it's the path to freedom. When we stop clinging to our own way, God's way becomes clear.

Truth to Confront the Lie

The Lie:

"If I let go, I'll lose everything I want."

God's Truth:

"Whoever loses his life for My sake will find it." ~ Matthew 16:25

The Lie:

"I know what's best for my life."

God's Truth:

"In all your ways acknowledge Him, and He will make straight your paths." ~ Proverbs 3:6

The Lie:

"Surrender means I'll miss out."

God's Truth:

"No good thing does He withhold from those who walk uprightly." ~ Psalm 84:11

Faith Builder

For years I fought to stay in control. I thought surrender meant losing, but prison taught me that holding on to my own way was what kept me bound.

When I began surrendering my decisions, my time, and my desires to God each day, I didn't lose my life — I found it. And what I found was better than anything I could have planned for myself.

Real-Life Scenario

A friend says, "I'll follow God in some areas, but there are things I'm not ready to give up." How could you help them see the freedom that comes with total surrender?

Exercise – My Surrender List

1. Write down three areas of your life you've been holding back from God.
2. Next to each, write a prayer of surrender, releasing it to Him.
3. Ask God to help you trust Him fully in those areas.

Reflection Questions

1) What area of your life is the hardest to surrender?

2) How might holding on to control be keeping you from God's best?

3) What practical step can you take today to yield this area to Him?

Faith in Action - Head, Heart, Hands

Challenge 1 – Personal:

Begin each day this week with a short prayer: “Lord, I surrender this day to You. Lead me in Your way.”

- **Head:** What truth am I affirming when I pray this?
 - **Heart:** How does praying this change my attitude for the day?
 - **Hands:** What action will I take today that reflects my surrender?
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Challenge 2 – Relational:

Ask a trusted believer to check in with you daily this week about one area you’re surrendering.

- **Head:** What truth do I want them to remind me of?
 - **Heart:** How does knowing someone is praying for me help me stay surrendered?
 - **Hands:** What will I do to encourage them in their own surrender?
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Action Steps

- Read Luke 9:23–24 and reflect on what it means to “take up your cross daily.”
 - Memorize Proverbs 3:5–6.
 - Identify one decision you’ve been making without prayer and commit to seek God first.
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Closing Prayer

Lord, today I choose to surrender every part of my life to You. Take my plans, my desires, and my fears, and replace them with Your will. Help me to trust that Your way is always better.

~ Amen.

Week 18 - Finishing The Race

Living Faithfully Until the End

Key Scripture

"I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith." ~ 2 Timothy 4:7

Quote from a Reformed Theologian

"It is not how you start the race that matters most, but how you finish — and you cannot finish in your own strength." ~ Charles Spurgeon

Memory Verse

"...let us run with endurance the race that is set before us, looking to Jesus, the founder and perfecter of our faith..." ~ Hebrews 12:1-2

Lesson Summary

The Christian life is not a sprint — it's a long, often challenging race. There will be hills, valleys, and obstacles along the way. Some days will feel like victory laps; others will feel like crawling toward the finish line.

Finishing well means:

- Keeping your eyes on Jesus as the goal, not just avoiding sin.
- Guarding your faith through prayer, the Word, and fellowship.
- Persevering through trials and not giving up, even when it's hard.

Our reward isn't in this life — it's hearing, "Well done, good and faithful servant" from the Lord Himself.

Truth to Confront the Lie

The Lie:

"I'm too tired to keep going."

God's Truth:

"Come to Me... and I will give you rest." ~ Matthew 11:28

The Lie:

"I've already failed too many times to finish well."

God's Truth:

"He who began a good work in you will bring it to completion." ~
Philippians 1:6

The Lie:

"It doesn't matter how I end, as long as I started strong."

God's Truth:

"Be faithful unto death, and I will give you the crown of life." ~
Revelation 2:10

Faith Builder

In prison, I saw men start strong with God, only to fade when the emotional high wore off or when trials came. I didn't want that to be my story.

I realized finishing the race wasn't about being the fastest — it was about being faithful. And every small, daily choice to trust God and obey Him was another step toward the finish line.

Real-Life Scenario

A friend says, "I don't know if I can keep living like this for the rest of my life." How would you help them see the value of endurance and the eternal reward ahead?

Exercise – My Finish Line Vision

1. Picture yourself standing before Jesus at the end of your life.
2. Write down what you hope to hear Him say to you.

3. List three choices you can make this week that will help you live toward that moment.

Reflection Questions

- 1)** What does “finishing the race” mean to you personally?

- 2)** What obstacles could try to slow you down or take you off course?

- 3)** Who can you run alongside to help both of you finish well?

Faith in Action - Head, Heart, Hands

Challenge 1 – Personal:

Choose one spiritual discipline (prayer, Bible reading, worship, service) to strengthen over the next month as part of running your race faithfully.

- **Head:** What truth motivates me to keep going?
 - **Heart:** How does focusing on the finish line give me hope?
 - **Hands:** What action will I take this week to stay on course?
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Challenge 2 – Relational:

Encourage someone who feels like giving up by reminding them that the race isn't over yet.

- **Head:** What Scripture will I share with them?
 - **Heart:** How does encouraging them strengthen my own faith?
 - **Hands:** How will I practically walk with them toward the finish?
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Action Steps

- Read Hebrews 12:1–3 every day this week.
 - Memorize 2 Timothy 4:7.
 - Identify one area of your spiritual life that needs renewed endurance.
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Closing Prayer

*Lord, give me the strength to run this race all the way to the finish. Keep
my eyes fixed on Jesus, my heart full of faith, and my hands ready for
Your work until the day I see You face to face.*

~ Amen.

Addiction doesn't have the final word. Truth does.

Unshackled Truth is more than a workbook — it's a weapon. With scripture, real-life reflection, and soul-deep prompts, this workbook guides you through the process of breaking free from the chains that once held you. Whether you're in recovery, reentry, or simply searching for hope, this workbook will meet you where you are—and walk with you toward healing.

Written by someone who's lived it, this is your invitation to discover the truth that sets you free.

